

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1308

By Hale

A RESOLUTION to recognize Commissioner Jeff Long of the Tennessee Department of Safety and Homeland Security on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those citizens who have dedicated their careers to the protection and well-being of the citizens of this State; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable person is Commissioner Jeff Long, who has served with distinction as Commissioner of the Tennessee Department of Safety and Homeland Security since 2019 and will soon be taking a much-deserved retirement; and

WHEREAS, Commissioner Long graduated from the University of Memphis with a Bachelor of Arts degree in Political Science and earned a Doctor of Jurisprudence degree from the Nashville School of Law; and

WHEREAS, Jeff Long's career in criminal justice spans more than fifty-three years and includes service as an Assistant District Attorney for the 21st Judicial District, Special Agent in Charge with the Tennessee Bureau of Investigation, Investigator for the 21st Judicial District, Arson Investigator with the Tennessee Fire Marshal's Office, Captain with the Williamson County Sheriff's Office, and Federal Hospital Police Officer with the Veterans Administration Hospital in Memphis; and

WHEREAS, in August 2008, he was elected Sheriff of Williamson County, in which capacity he earned the respect and admiration of both his colleagues and the citizens he served through his steadfast commitment to public safety and effective law enforcement; and

WHEREAS, Commissioner Long was appointed Commissioner of the Tennessee Department of Safety and Homeland Security by Governor Bill Lee and was sworn in immediately following the governor's inauguration in January 2019, and he was also appointed to serve as the Governor's Homeland Security Advisor for the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, additional responsibilities entrusted to Commissioner Long include service on the Tennessee Criminal Justice Investment Task Force and leadership as chair of the Violent Crime Task Force; and

WHEREAS, among his numerous honors and commendations are the Task Force Against Domestic Violence Law Enforcement Award, recognition from the John Marshall American Inns of Court, the Master Hall of Fame Morris Heithcock Lodge 41 Fraternal Order of Police Award, an honorary doctorate from Williamson College, and a commendation from FBI Director William S. Sessions; and

WHEREAS, Commissioner Long's many accolades also include the Williamson County Impact Award, designation as the Law Enforcement Officer of the Year by the Williamson County Bar Association, the Sons of the American Revolution Law Enforcement Commendation Medal, and the Tennessee Sheriff of the Year Award; and

WHEREAS, he also had the honor of serving on the Dignitary Protection Detail for presidents Ronald Reagan, Bill Clinton, George H. W. Bush, and George W. Bush, as well as for Princess Anne, daughter of Queen Elizabeth II; and

WHEREAS, a respected leader in his profession, Jeff Long is a former president of the Tennessee Sheriffs' Association and a current member of the National Sheriffs' Association and the International Association of Chiefs of Police; in 2014, he was appointed by Governor Bill Haslam to serve as a member of the Peace Officer Standards and Training Commission; and

WHEREAS, his many accomplishments aside, Commissioner Long is most grateful for the love and support of his wife, Dora, and their children, Julie and Justin, and their five grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Jeff Long exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Commissioner Long has proven himself to be wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee

recognition as the Volunteer State, and he should be specially recognized for his many years of honorable and astute service to the citizens of this State; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Commissioner Jeff Long upon his retirement as Commissioner of the Tennessee Department of Safety and Homeland Security, thank him for his many years of dedicated service, and extend to him our best wishes for every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.